



*Figure 1-2: A linter points out an undefined variable in Mu (top), PyCharm (middle), and Sublime Text (bottom).*

The near-instant notifications that a linter provides greatly improves your programming productivity. Without one, you'd have to run your program, watch it crash, read the traceback, and then find the line in your source code to fix a typo. And if you've made multiple typos, this run-fix cycle would only find them one at a time. Linting can point out multiple errors at once, and it does so directly in the editor, so you can see the line on which they occur.

Your editor or IDE might not come with a lint feature, but if it supports plug-ins, almost certainly a linter will be available. Often, these plug-ins use a linting module called Pyflakes or some other module to do their analysis. You can install Pyflakes from <https://pypi.org/project/pyflakes/> or by running `pip install --user pyflakes`. It's well worth the effort.